Teacher Quick Guide

How to Prepare for an ARD Meeting

A simple checklist for general and special education teachers

STEP 1 — 2-3 WEEKS BEFORE

Gather your information

- [ ] Complete teacher input forms (grades, strengths, needs)
- [ ] Collect work samples and assessment data
- [ ] Note which accommodations the student uses and how often
- [ ] Confirm the meeting time and send calendar invites to all attendees

STEP 2 — Day Of

At the meeting

- [ ] Start with a strength. Families remember how you open
- [ ] Encourage parents and attendees to share ideas and ask questions
- [ ] Share data in plain language, without jargon
- [ ] Summarize decisions and next steps before closing

STEP 3 — After

After the meeting

- [ ] Review the final IEP and accommodations list
- [ ] Update lesson plans, seating, and testing supports
- [ ] Begin tracking progress on the new goals
- [ ] Reach out to the case manager with any questions

Key Terms

ARD: A meeting where the committee plans out the special education services

IEP: The student's individualized educational plan with goals and supports

Accommodation: Changes *how* a student learns or shows learning

Modification: Changes *what* a student is expected to learn

Quick Tip: Say this, not that

✗ **"He doesn't want to work."**

✓ **"He starts work on his own 1 out of 6 times and usually needs 4–5 prompts to begin."**

✗ **"She isn't really good at math."**

✓ **"On average, she completes 2 out of 6 problems correctly on her own."**

✗ **"Let's discuss the BIP and LRE."**

✓ **"Let's talk about the behavior plan and the setting he works best in."**

Questions? Contact your special education coordinator.